



FAMILY COURT DATA REPORT · STATE SERIES · NO. 6

COLORADO

WHAT FAMILIES ARE REPORTING.

Pulled from the Family Rights Registry — the first cross-state dataset on what pro se parents are actually experiencing inside Colorado's family courts and child-welfare system.

52

COLORADO FAMILIES ON RECORD · 45
CHILDREN IMPACTED · 24 MONTHS
MEDIAN MONTHS LOST OF PARENTING
TIME

REPORT GENERATED
APRIL 26, 2026

COUNTIES REPRESENTED
19 OF 64

COMPILED BY
MEG · STANDWITHMEG.COM

THE HEADLINE NUMBERS

COLORADO AT A GLANCE.

Across 52 Colorado families reporting through the Family Rights Registry, the patterns are consistent: long durations in court, serious financial loss, and a disproportionate number of parents going unrepresented because they ran out of money fighting.

CHILDREN IMPACTED 45 52 of 52 families reported child counts	MEDIAN ATTORNEY FEES \$19,000 per reporting family	MEDIAN MONTHS LOST 24 of parenting time	WENT PRO SE 69.2% 28.8% after running out of money
SUBMISSIONS 52	AVG CHILDREN / FAMILY 0.9	FAMILIES REPORTING CHILDREN 52 of 52	COUNTIES REPRESENTED 19

WHY THIS REPORT EXISTS.

On January 29, 2024, I lost custody of all five of my children.

- NO TRIAL.
- NO QUESTIONING.
- NO SUBSTANTIATED ABUSE.

It took only a signature on an ex parte emergency order to erase a mother. I refused to disappear. I fought back, and built the Family Rights Registry so Colorado families — and families in every state — would stop being invisible to the data. This report is their record.

— MEG · [STANDWITHMEG.COM](https://standwithmeg.com)

02 THE COST OF COLORADO FAMILY COURT

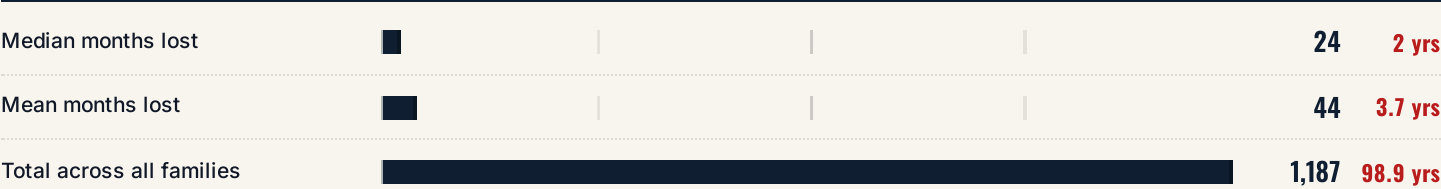
Legal fees are the largest reported expense, but they are not the only one. Lost wages, evaluation costs, and reunification services compound the financial loss — pushing most families toward pro se representation once their savings run out.

EXPENSE CATEGORY	RESPONSES	MEDIAN	MEAN	TOTAL REPORTED
Attorney Fees	25	\$19,000	\$51,400	\$1,285,000
Lost Wages	26	\$31,500	\$246,062	\$6,397,610
Other Court Fees	20	\$1,500	\$6,150	\$123,000
Therapy / Evaluations	23	\$2,520	\$7,975	\$183,420
Reunification Services	20	\$400	\$2,279	\$45,580
GAL Fees	20	\$0	\$1,490	\$29,800
Asset Loss ¹	30	\$82,500	—	—
Estimated Median Family Impact	—	\$137,420	—	—

Median vs. mean: Median is the middle reported amount, so it better reflects the typical reporting family when a few very large expenses appear. Mean is the average across reporting families and can be pulled higher by outliers.

1. On asset loss: One respondent reported an extreme outlier that skews the mean beyond usefulness. We report the median (\$82,500) and suppress the mean and total, pending data-quality review. Lost Wages also contains wide variance; median is the honest headline.

LOST PARENTING TIME · MONTHS



03 WHO IS REPORTING · COLORADO

Most families documenting in Colorado are currently active in, or recently closed out of, long-running cases. Nearly half have lost all contact with their children.

CASE STATUS · SYSTEM AFFECTED

CASE STATUS

Active case: stuck or delayed		22	42%
Not provided		16	31%
Case closed: more than 2 years ago		10	19%
Case closed: within last 2 years		4	8%

SYSTEM AFFECTED

Family Court Only		19	37%
Both Family Court and CPS		17	33%
Unknown		12	23%
CPS (Child Protective Services) Only		4	8%

DURATION · CUSTODY OUTCOMES

TIME IN SYSTEM

1 – 3 years		13	25%
Over 10 years		8	15%
5 – 10 years		7	13%
3 – 5 years		6	12%
5+ years		6	12%

CUSTODY STATUS

No Contact / Total Loss of Access		20	38%
Visitation Only		9	17%
50/50 Joint		8	15%
Full Custody		7	13%
Partial / Shared		3	6%

GEOGRAPHY · ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

TOP COUNTIES

El Paso		4	8%
Douglas		4	8%
Larimer		3	6%
Arapahoe		3	6%
Weld		3	6%
Pueblo		2	4%

TOP ALLEGATIONS REPORTED

Family Court False Accusations (Domestic Violence/Abuse/Alienation)		13	25%
False Accusations CPS (Non-Medical) (Vengeful ex-partner, malicious report)		7	13%
High Conflict Divorce		6	12%
Child Protective Services (CPS / DCF)		6	12%
Other: (Short answer)		4	8%

05 PARENT VOICES — COLORADO

Quotes appear as submitted. Long submissions are trimmed with [...] to fit the page; the full unedited quote is available in the online version of this report.



The system has destroyed my son. ,my Family my life my finances, and my local welding business .,My son was ripped away from his aunt ,brothers, cousins, community , friends and school and me his father, and moved 540 miles away. All based upon false allegations ,and proven lies [...]

— KENNETH

ON THE REPORTED ALLEGATIONS

Torn us apart. Lack of due process nearly destroyed a close relationship between mother and son

— COLORADO PARENT · ANONYMOUS

MORE VOICES FROM COLORADO

For over 14 months, my sons' futures have been treated as collateral damage in a scorched-earth strategy where a "childlike" need for control has replaced actual parenting. What is being called "maternal security" is actually a calculated act of deception. This "single mother" [...]

— JUSTIN

CPS was not there to help even after repeated reports of abuse and DV. The court still allows the children time with their abusive father even after findings of abuse, coercive control and DV was made. The court is allowing legal and financial abuse to continue as well as [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Absolute destruction, trauma, abuse, financial ruin. Incarceration.

— RYAN

Separated and destroyed siblings bonding and growing up together. Traumatizing children and retraumatizing the adult who was abused by vindictive adopted parents.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It has traumatized my kids and myself in ways that I believe are irreparable

— CHARLENE

Family court is where the Constitution of the United States is best used to wipe ones ass, Judges and attorneys know it, lies and false accusations are normal and truth does not matter.

— MIKE

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



This system didn't just separate me from my children—it took years of love, connection, and memories we can never replace.

— ALYSSA

It's destroyed me inside and out.

— KASSY

I have lost everything due to the system and how it treats fathers. Child support alone has kept me homeless for a decade of my life despite me working full time. The system incentivizes conflict and separation of families without regard for who it's hurting. The judges and [...]

— JASON

I had to bury a child and was kept from protecting my other two older children from abuse for 15 years, I lost my relationship with my children altogether, and was deprived from being a mother forever.

— ALISHIA

Legalized abuse. Kidnapped and tortured childhood and parenthood. Created everlasting trauma for child and safe parent. There truly are not words. Humanitarian Crisis for profit. Pure Evil.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Destroyed us and caused trauma and damages for our future

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

The system failed my children and protected a narcissist mom

— ANDREW

Stripped me of my title as a mom

— MIRANDA

Stolen my son, violating rights to safety and love for both of us. I waited to be a mom, and didn't want to miss any of it but now I'm prevented from all and he's in a home of horror.

— MARY

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



Put me in jail, emotionally traumatized me and my daughter, and had to start my life completely over from scratch.

— CHRIS

These experiences deeply traumatized our family, undermined our stability, and forced us to live in constant crisis-management mode. Instead of focusing on healing and growth, we were consumed by defending ourselves and trying to survive broken systems.

— MICHELLE

The system destroyed my family and now as my adult daughter still deals with the repercussions to this day, I know something needs to be done now to stop this!

— AMANDA

The system left me living in a camper while rewarding the man who harmed us, and taught my daughters to value resources over safety.

— JULIE

Denied justice due process and it cost me everything. Now I feel like I'm being harassed by child support.

— MARK

The system tried to kill me and erase my from my child's life. My ex manipulated my own family and tried to get them to testify against me as harshly as possible so as to do th most damage that he possibly could. My son was only three years old and was ripped away from me. I was [...]

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

It's made me feel like I'm not a Good Mother. Even though I know I do my best as a Single Mother. It's Harassing me.

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

Separated us,... Lives and memories lost,... Its affected my health tremendously Iv always thought they placed her with Unsafe people they have a criminal background and guns in there homes I put photos in my book the missing that shows photos of my daughter near guns they have [...]

— LINDSEY

They broke us when we looked to them for a voice of reason... Lied cheated and stole under the color or law

— ANONYMOUS PARENT

05 PARENT VOICES, CONTINUED



Complete destruction of ability to thrive, depleting my parents retirement savings, extreme constant stress to child, me, my parents my siblings and their children. Straining and diminishing any/all meaningful relationships as this is too much for anyone close to hear in detail [...]

— AUBREE

Taking my daughter as an infant, when her father was absent. Not taking breastfeeding seriously, or developmental needs. Ignoring doctors and specialists. Ignoring evidence of substance use around child and witness testimony.

— JANELLE

The Magistrate belittled me for an hour at the last hearing. Threatening to take my child away from me because I wasn't "flexable". All because I was following the court order. No where can anyone show me a law or state statute that mandates me to be flexible instead in leu of a [...]

— KELLEY

The system is built on, whoever makes the loudest accusations or has the most money I came to court with timeline, documented evidence, and proof of competence... it was dismissed and I was restricted even after proof through DHS clearing me NO FINDINGS.

— EVELYNN

it has ruined my family's dynamic, we used to be close and now all of us have a form of ptsd and are experiencing that in the courts. we do not trust these caseworkers to ever do their jobs properly.

— PRISCILLA

31 Colorado parents submitted ranked quotes. 31 appear in this report; the remainder are available at standwithmeg.com/co.

06 HOW TO READ THIS REPORT

WHAT THIS IS

The Family Rights Registry is a national, parent-reported data collection run by Stand With Meg. Every figure in this Colorado report comes from Colorado respondents who voluntarily submitted survey entries about their experience inside family court and/or CPS.

This report is built to help families, advocates, reporters, and legislators see the patterns emerging in Colorado — not to replace formal research, and not to name individual judges or counties as responsible parties.

WHAT IT ISN'T

This is not a representative sample. Respondents self-select. The 52 Colorado families reporting here are not the universe of Colorado families in court — they are the families who found the survey, trusted it enough to submit, and told us what happened to them.

Financial figures are self-reported. We flag outliers and report medians when means are distorted (see page 3, note 1). Quotes are minimally edited.

METHODOLOGY · FAMILY RIGHTS REGISTRY

Data in this report was collected April 2024 – April 2026 through standwithmeg.com/family-rights-survey. Submissions are timestamped. Duplicate-submission heuristics use normalized email + location, with direct survey rows preferred over legacy rows and the newest row retained within each source. Categorical responses from multi-select and short-answer fields are normalized monthly.

When a respondent's financial entry differs from the population by more than three standard deviations, the mean is suppressed and only the median is reported. Lost-wage, attorney-fee, and asset-loss entries are self-reported and not corroborated against tax records or court filings.

Geographic reporting uses the county field as submitted, with light normalization (e.g. "Butte silverbow" → "Butte–Silver Bow"). Quotes carry one of three public permission states: *Anonymous*, *First-name only*, or *Full attribution with consent to public use*. Court actor names appear only after 5 independent families name the same actor.

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ABOUT THIS REPORT

This report is based on self-reported survey submissions collected by Stand With Meg. Counts and categories reflect responses available at the time this packet was generated.

This report is for informational and advocacy use only, not legal advice or an official government record.

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